

2.1a

Perception

Influences on perception

Selective attention

Through selective attention, our awareness focuses on only one thing at a time.

Our mind takes in ~ 11 bits of info per second
of that, we consciously process ~ 40 .

The rest goes to our subconscious.

ex. Cocktail party effect: Ability to attend to only one voice within a sea of many as you chat with a party guest

But even here, a voice speaking your name instantly brings that unattended voice into consciousness.

Selective Attention & Accidents

~60% of americans have read or sent a text while driving.

Our selective attention shifts very frequently

When a driver is in a conversation, activity in brain regions vital to driving decreases by 37%

Distracted driving kills ~9 americans daily

Driver distraction occurred before ~58% of teen crashes

Talking to passengers → 1.6x crash risk

Using phone (incl. hands free) → 4x crash risk

(equal to risk of drunk driving)

Study of long-haul truckers found that while texting → 23x increase in crash risk

Inattentional blindness

we're "blind" to most visual stimuli.

When our attention is directed or focused elsewhere, we fail to see obvious visible objects
∴ Inattentional blindness

Studies have demonstrated people failing to notice very obvious things, like gorillas, when they are very focused on something else.

Change blindness is a form of inattentional blindness.

It is failing to notice changes in the environment, especially when change occurs gradually or between brief disruptions.

Expectations, Context, Motivation & Emotion

Info processing occurs both from

- Bottom up: beginning w/ sensory receptors
- Top down: drawing from experience & expectations

Perceptual Set

Experience → we expect certain results.

Expectations give us a **perceptual set**: a set of mental tendencies & assumptions that affects, top-down, what we sense.

Our expectations will affect how we perceive all our senses

Through experience, we form concepts: **Schemas**, that **organize & interpret unfamiliar info**

Our **pre-existing schemas** affect how we apply TDP to interpret ambiguous sensations.

Stereotypes strongly affect perception

Context, Motivation & Emotion.

As well as perceptual set, **immediate context, motivation & emotion** affect our interpretations.

Context:

Varying cultures may view things differently
context helps to fill in **sounds**

Motivations:

desirable objects seem closer than they are

closer objects seem more desirable

hills seem steeper while carrying a heavy load

Emotions:

hearing sad music leads to sadder perception of homophonic words.

Personal Connection:

during third, I CS for Mr. Waterman. He has a student in his grade 8 class called 'haveen'. Despite knowing this, when Mr. Waterman says Naveen's name, I nearly always hear mine, due to similarity & experience.

MCQ

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5. b. 6. a 7. b.